NURTURING NATURE

NEEM BABA

1



Amber returned from school and sat down in the shade of the neem tree in her courtyard. She felt that the tree was whispering to her. She looked at the tree and spoke to the tree.

2



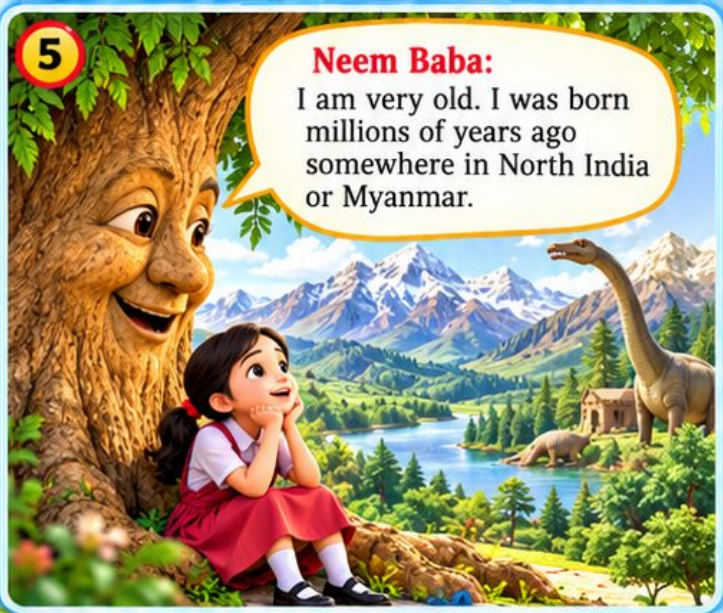
3



4



5



6



NURTURING NATURE

NEEM BABA

1

Amber:
Outside India? Where else can neem be found?

2

Neem Baba:
My family can be found in many Asian and African countries and even in some parts of America.



3

Amber:
That's wonderful! Who gave you your name?

4

Neem Baba:
The story of my name is very thought-provoking. I was born in India and given Sanskrit names such as *Arishta* (the one who cures diseases), *Nimba* and *Nimbaca*.

5

Neem Baba:
The name "Neem" is given by the Iranians.

6

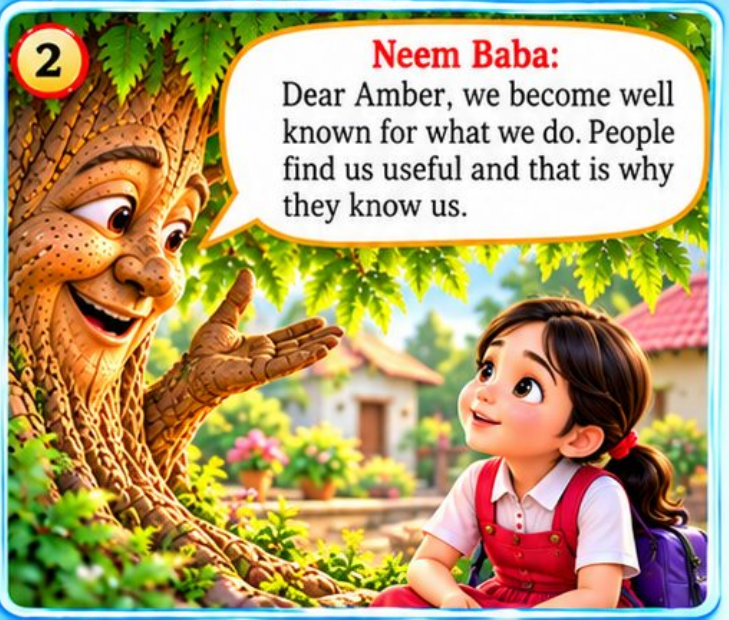
Neem Baba:
Yes, in Hindi, my name is *Nimb*. In India, I have other names—*Nim*, *Leemba*, *Nimori*, *Nimbamand*, *Nimbe* and *Nimo*.

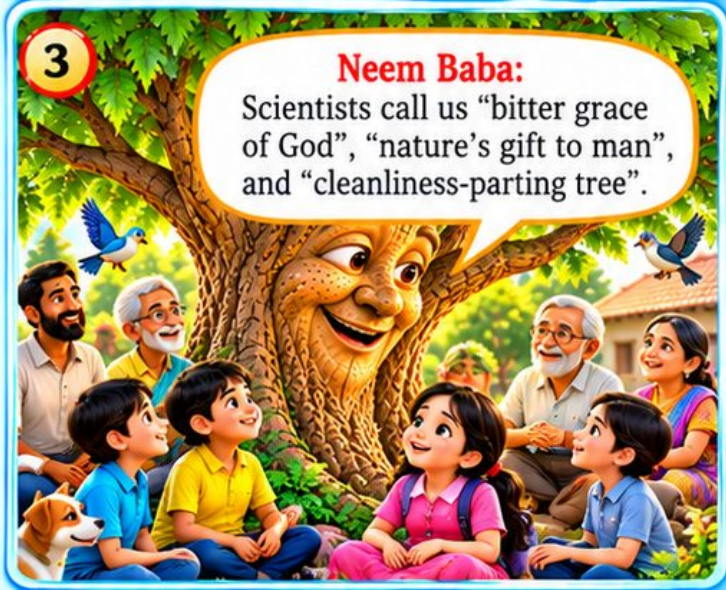
Nimb
Nim
Leemba
Nimori
Nimbamand
Nimbe
Nimo

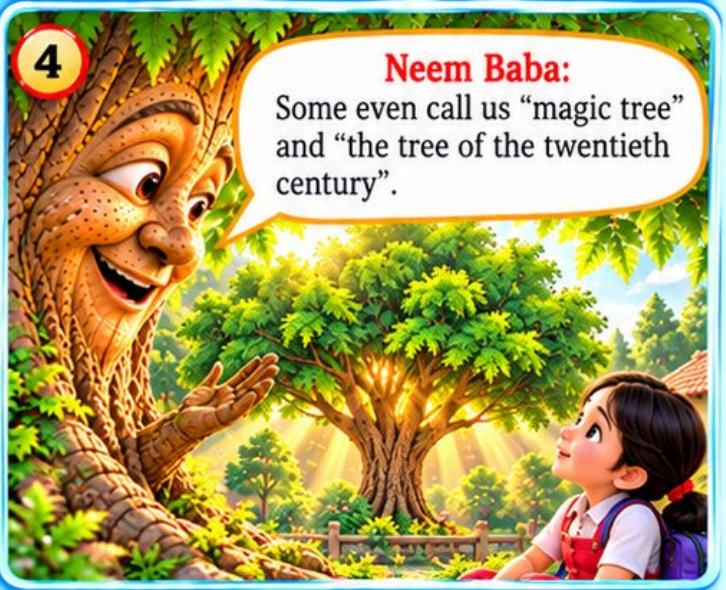
NURTURING NATURE

NEEM BABA

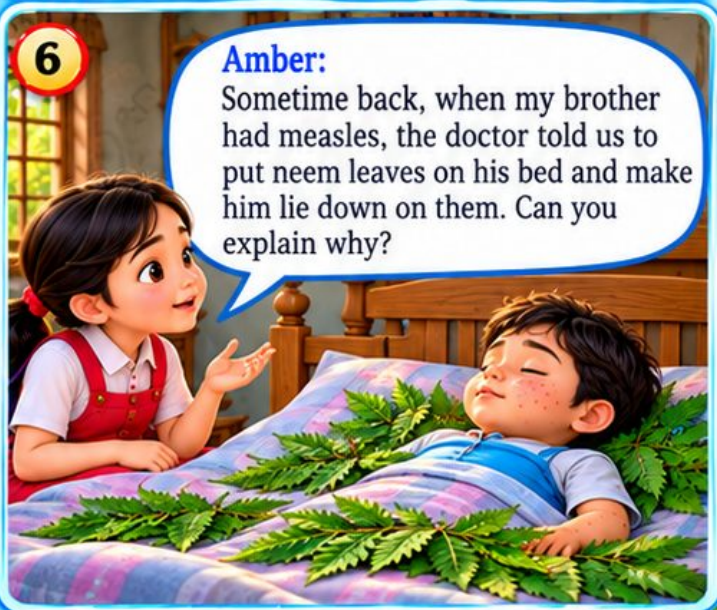












NURTURING NATURE

NEEM BABA

1

Neem Baba:
The doctors know that neem leaves have chemical properties that destroy germs.



2

Neem Baba:
Measles cause itching all over the body. Neem leaves give comfort and do not allow germs to breed.



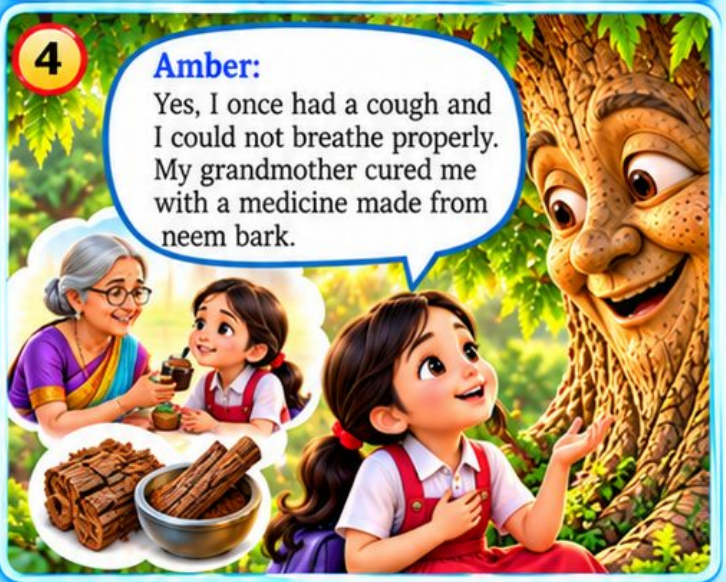
3

Neem Baba:
Neem leaves, bark, flowers, fruits and even roots can be used to make medicines to cure many diseases.



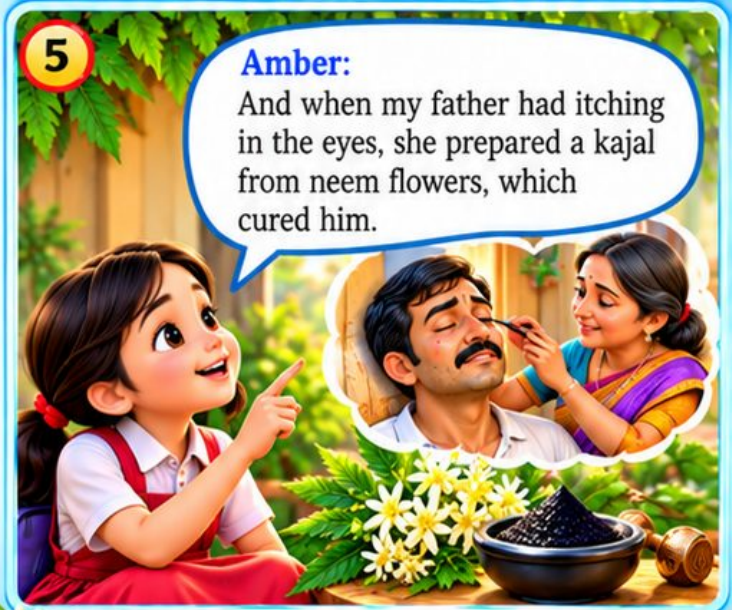
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Amber:
Yes, I once had a cough and I could not breathe properly. My grandmother cured me with a medicine made from neem bark.



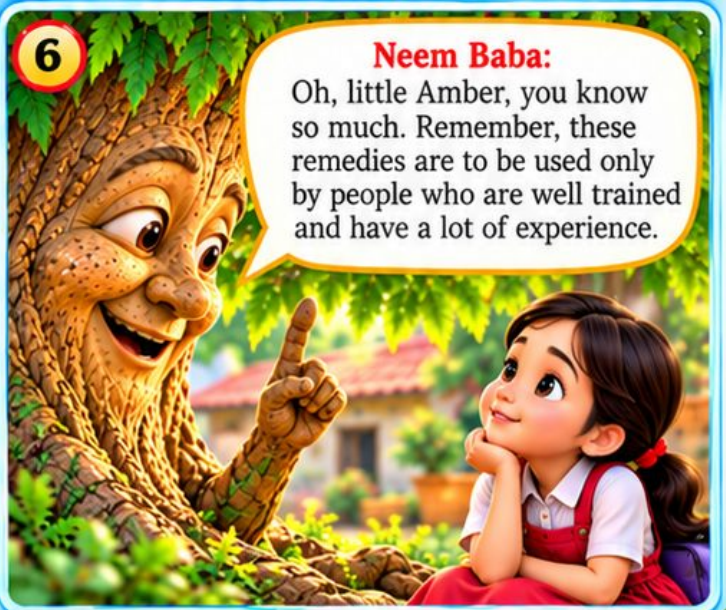
5

Amber:
And when my father had itching in the eyes, she prepared a kajal from neem flowers, which cured him.



6

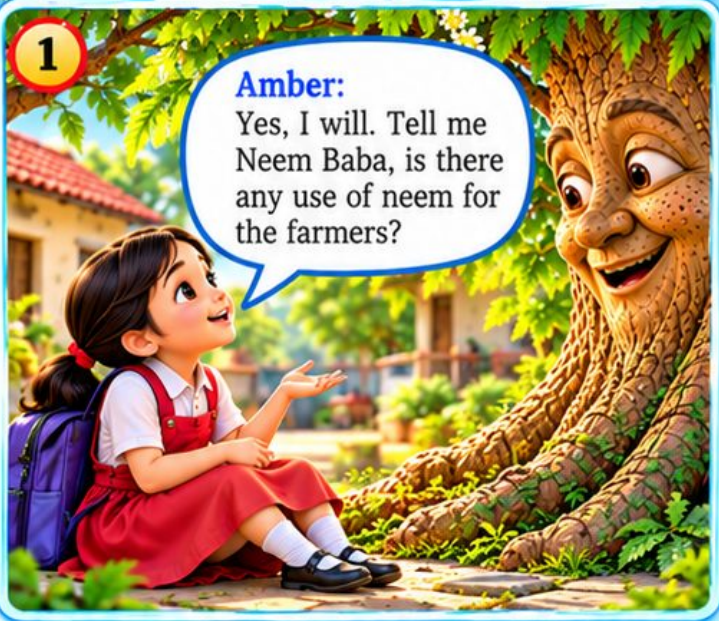
Neem Baba:
Oh, little Amber, you know so much. Remember, these remedies are to be used only by people who are well trained and have a lot of experience.



NURTURING NATURE

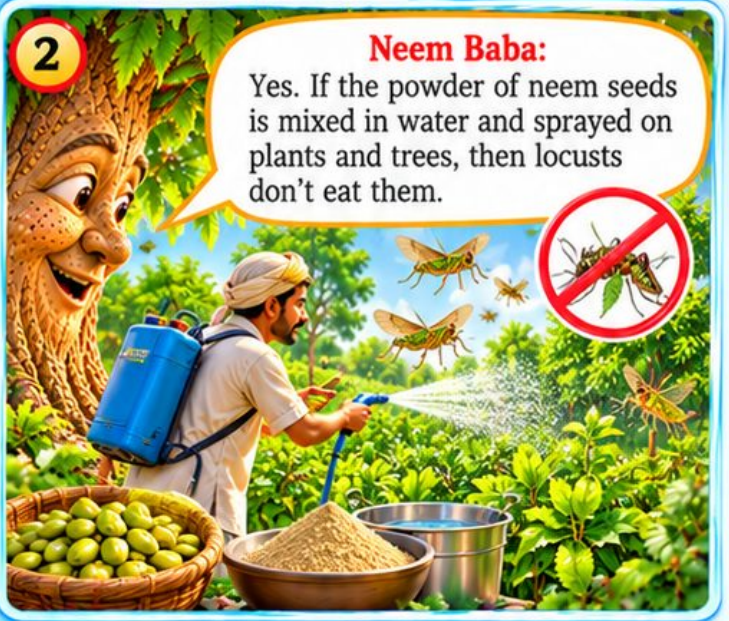
NEEM BABA

1



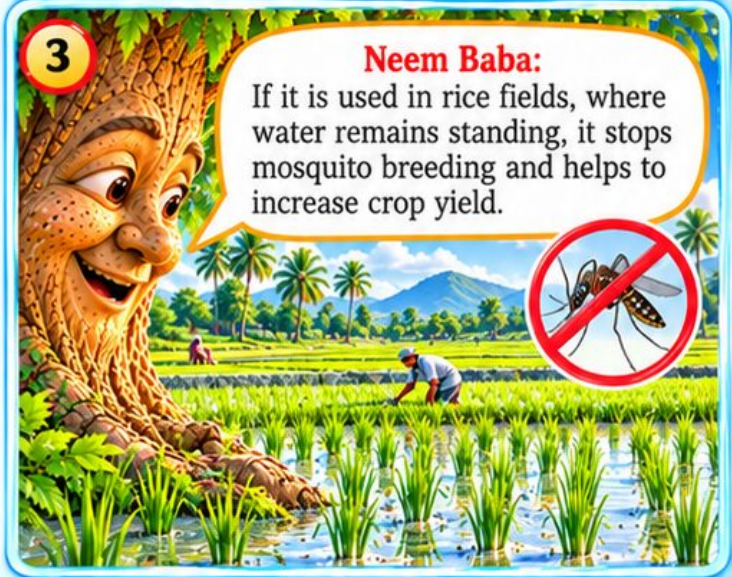
Amber:
Yes, I will. Tell me Neem Baba, is there any use of neem for the farmers?

2



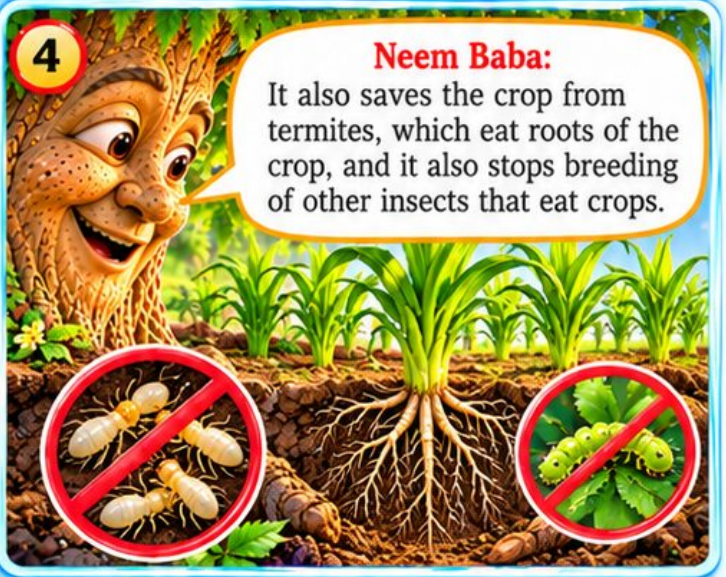
Neem Baba:
Yes. If the powder of neem seeds is mixed in water and sprayed on plants and trees, then locusts don't eat them.

3



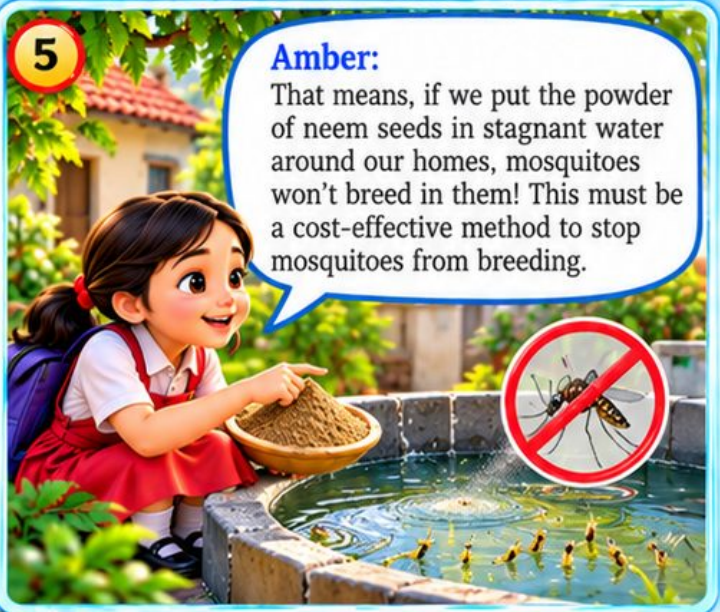
Neem Baba:
If it is used in rice fields, where water remains standing, it stops mosquito breeding and helps to increase crop yield.

4



Neem Baba:
It also saves the crop from termites, which eat roots of the crop, and it also stops breeding of other insects that eat crops.

5



Amber:
That means, if we put the powder of neem seeds in stagnant water around our homes, mosquitoes won't breed in them! This must be a cost-effective method to stop mosquitoes from breeding.

6



Neem Baba:
Of course. People save their stored grains from insects by adding neem seed powder to them. Neem oil is also used to make soaps and toothpaste. Furniture made from neem wood is not eaten by termites.

NURTURING NATURE

NEEM BABA

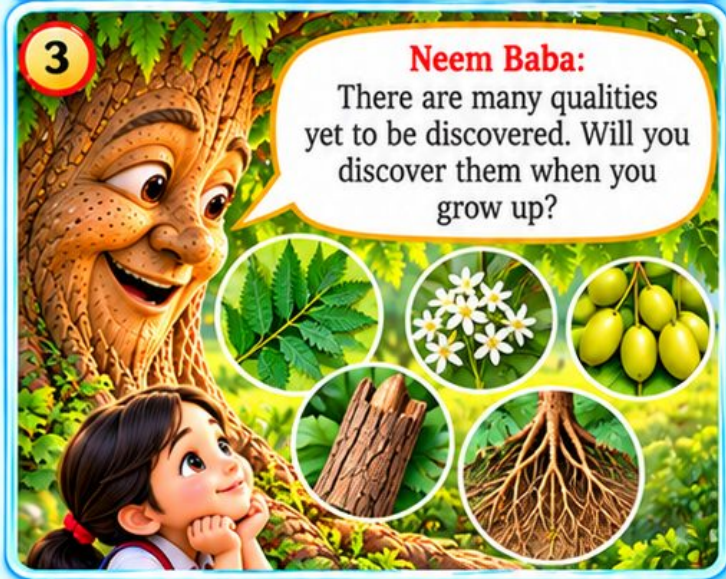
1



2



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Adapted from Neem Baba by S. I. Farooqi